



The market repriced the network alongside the migration. ZEC went from \$407 on June 30 to \$836 on August 31, a 106% gain, and its August 24 daily average of

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Network fundamentals kept pace. Mining difficulty rose 35% to an all-time high, distinct mining addresses winning blocks averaged 16 per day in August, the most since 2020, and two corporate miners committed about \$65M to Zcash hashrate. Shielded-pool throughput fell 7% in native terms but rose 23% in dollars, and the last two weeks of August were the busiest shielded weeks since the June deshielding rush. Google search interest fell in July to its lowest reading since September 2025 and recovered only slightly in August; the migration drew no measurable outside attention.

Development moved from emergency response to scheduling. The Ironwood balance-integrity proof completed on activation day. zcashd halted for good on July 18. NU7 still has no mainnet height; a coinholder vote that opened August 25 and closes September 14 decides whether to ship it by September 30 with unfinished features cut, and whether to adopt 25-second blocks and smoothed issuance. Block time held at 75 seconds through August. The open item is the 470K ZEC still in Orchard, which a full node cannot re-verify until it crosses the turnstile; the migration rate fell to 46K ZEC in the last week of August, so the residual is a tail, not a queue.



Shielded Pools

Zcash splits its supply across pools with different privacy guarantees. Transparent holds ZEC that behaves like Bitcoin, fully visible on-chain. Sprout and Sapling are legacy shielded pools. Orchard was the current-generation pool until the June soundness bug and has been sealed to deposits since July 28, withdraw-only through the turnstile, the one-way accounting gate that lets any node check that no more value leaves a pool than verifiably entered it. Ironwood is its replacement, a fresh pool with a corrected and formally verified circuit that started at zero on activation day. Lockbox is a governance-controlled reserve funded by block rewards. The split matters because it shows whether holders actually use the privacy that justifies ZEC as a distinct asset; a network with 95% of supply in Transparent is a smaller Bitcoin. This quarter it answers a narrower question:

ielded balance into a brand-new pool on the
s exodus would come back.

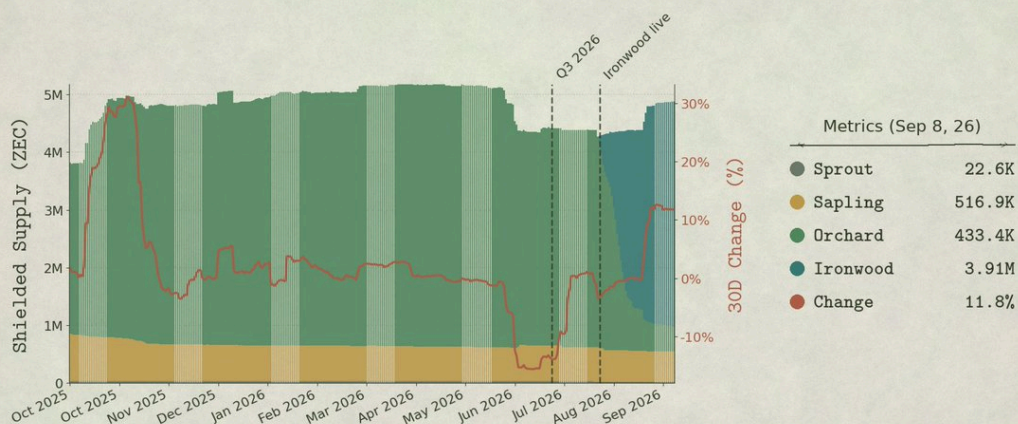
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Zcash Shielded Supply by Pool

Daily pool balances vs. 30-day supply momentum · Q4 2025 - Q3 2026



Data as of: September 8, 2026
Source: Blockworks Analytics

Pine Analytics

Pool balances

Shielded ZEC rose 9.9% between June 30 and August 31, from 4.42M to 4.86M, a net gain of 440K. Block-reward issuance over the window was 111K ZEC, and all of it lands in Transparent or Lockbox first, so the whole shielded gain came from holders moving coins out of Transparent, which shrank by 342K. The shielded share of supply recovered from 26.3% to 28.7%, against a 31% peak in early April, and 440K is 59% of the 745K that deshielded in Q2. Most of the re-shielding happened in one stretch: Transparent lost about 410K ZEC in the week of August 17, worth roughly \$230M at the time, as ZEC climbed through \$565 in the week before the ETF listing.

The migration is the larger story, and the base rate makes the point. When Sapling opened in October 2018, Sprout holders moved 8% of that pool in the first five weeks and 54% in the first year. When Orchard opened in May 2022, Sapling holders moved 1.2% in five weeks, and Orchard needed two and a half years to overtake Sapling. Ironwood went live on July 28 and held 3.84M ZEC on August 31, 79% of all shielded supply. Orchard fell from 3.77M ZEC on June 30 to 470K, so 87% of the balance that carried the counterfeiting risk has left the pool, nearly all of it through the turnstile into Ironwood. The pace was front-loaded: 955K ZEC by August 3, 2.44M by August 10, 3.08M by August 17, 3.73M by August 24, then a tail end; Sprout slipped 2.8K to 22.6K.

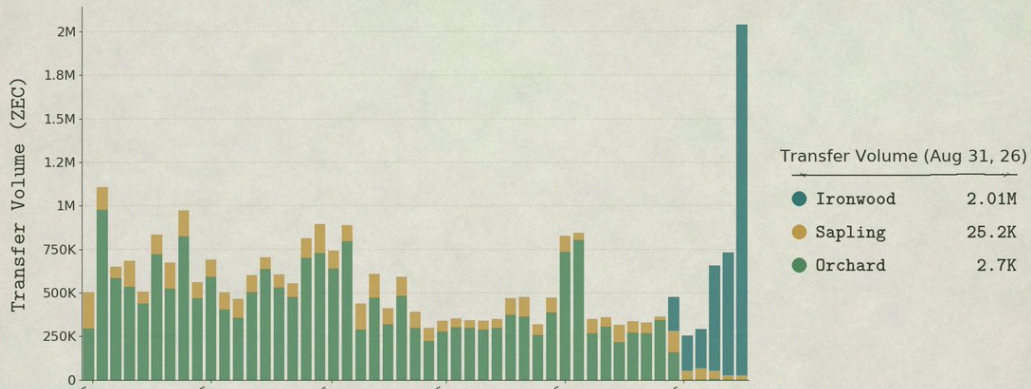
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Zcash Shielded-Pool Transfer Volume

Weekly volume transferred by shielded pool · from Q4 2025



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Pool flows

Native throughput through the shielded pools ran at 59K ZEC per day in July and August, 7% below Q2's 64K, while the dollar figure rose 23%, from \$29M to \$35M per day, on the higher price. Ironwood carried 32K ZEC per day of that, Orchard's residual 19K per day was almost entirely July, and Sapling ran at 8.5K per day, half its Q1 rate. The quarter's flow arrived late. The weeks of August 17 and August 24 carried 656K and 732K ZEC, the two busiest shielded weeks since the June deshielding rush, and both were mostly Ironwood. Migration inflates the late-July and early-August bars, because a coin leaving Orchard for Ironwood counts as volume in both pools. The August 24 week is a different thing: Orchard lost only 46K ZEC that week, so the 705K that moved through Ironwood was almost all ZEC changing hands inside the new pool during the price run.

Transaction counts moved later than volume. Shielded transactions averaged 1,272 per day in July and 1,599 in August, with Ironwood alone at 1,103 per day in August. Sixty percent of August's Ironwood transactions were deshields by count while the pool's balance kept rising, so the deshields are small and the shields are large. Who is on either side of them is not visible from the counts.

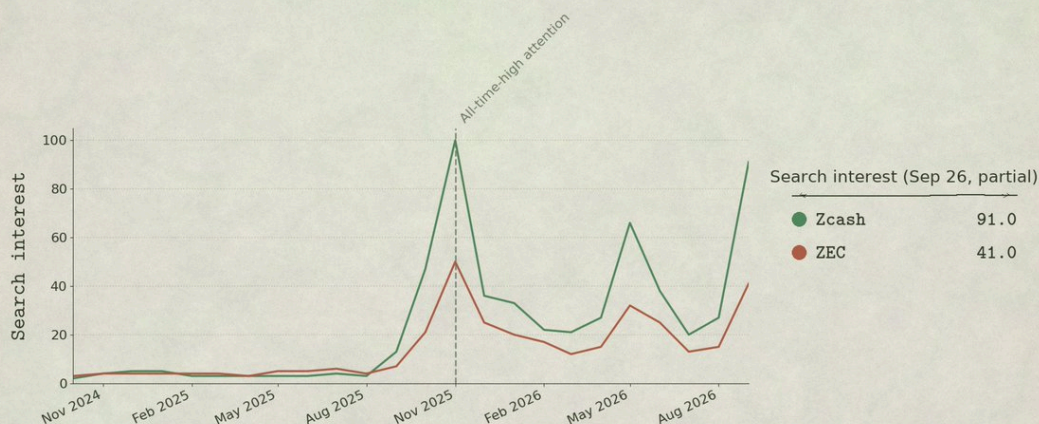
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ZCASH ATTENTION RETURNS TO PEAK LEVELS

Google Trends search interest — 'Zcash' vs 'ZEC', United States, past 2 years (monthly, Nov 2025 = 100)



Data as of: September 6, 2026
Source: Google Trends

Pine Analytics

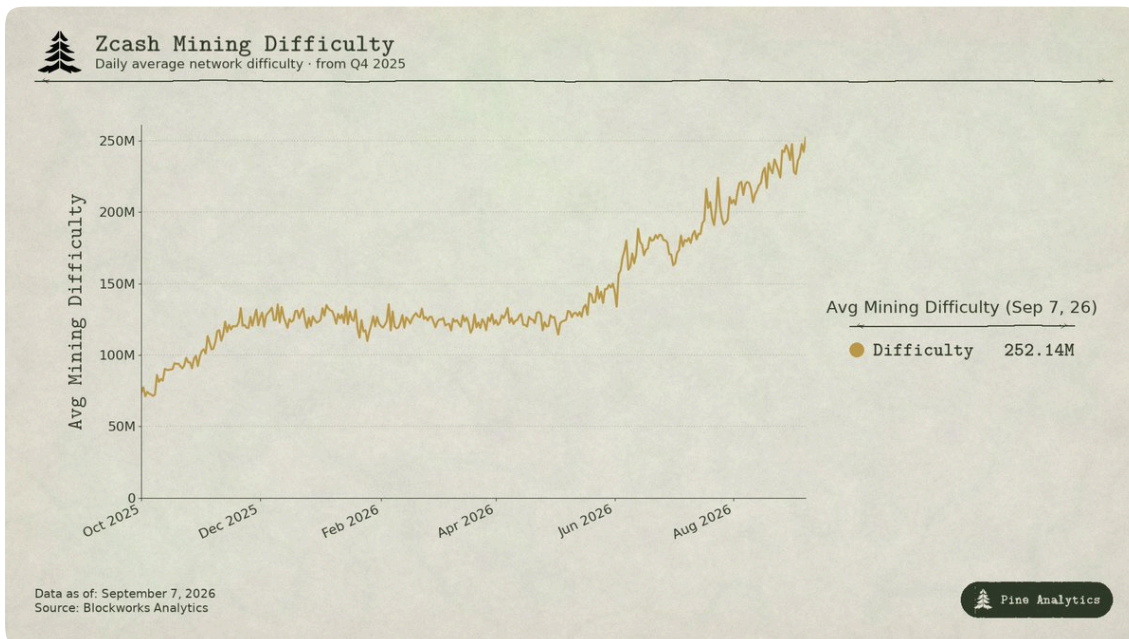
Network Attention



Google search interest for "Zcash" in the United States fell to 20 in July on a scale where November 2025 equals 100, its lowest monthly reading since September 2025, and recovered to 27 in August. Q2 averaged 44 across its three months, lifted by the 66 posted in May during the Multicoin disclosure and the Orchard bug; July and August together averaged 24. Ironwood launched on July 28 and the migration of 3.7M ZEC through late August drew no measurable outside attention, and the price doubling drew little more; the August reading sits at the level of March, before the Q2 run began. "Zcash" searches ran at roughly twice the "ZEC" ticker throughout, unchanged from prior quarters. Google re-scales the index on every pull, so these readings do not match the Q2 chart's values point for point; May reads 66 here and 51 there. For Q3 to match Q2's average, September would need to print above 84, a level reached only in November 2025.

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Mining Metrics



Mining difficulty rose 35% between the end of June and the end of August, from a 178M seven-day average to 241M, and the August 31 daily average of 248M is an all-time high. Difficulty kept rising through the late-July retrace to \$457 as well as the late-August run above \$800. Distinct mining addresses winning blocks averaged 13.9 per day in July and 16.0 in August, the most since 2020 and more than double the 7.1 of July 2025, though still below the 25 per day the network saw in September 2018. Block time held at 75 seconds, so NU7's 25-second target has not reached mainnet. Average block size rose from 16 KB in June to 35 KB in August, the first sign of the throughput pressure Tachyon is meant to relieve.

The hashrate now has corporate owners. Fortitude, the DCG mining subsidiary that is merging into a Nasdaq listing, bought 9,000 Antminer Z15 Pros for \$31.5M on July 30 for delivery in October and November, and added a 12.5 MW site in Nebraska on August 4. Cypherpunk Technologies, which held 323K ZEC (1.9% of supply) at the end of June, bought a fleet running about 4.2 GSol/s, roughly 18% of the network, from Winklevoss Capital for \$33M in stock on August 18. Fees remain 'K in August against block rewards near all under 1% of miner revenue.

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Network Development



Ironwood activation and the Orchard tail

Ironwood activated on July 28 at block 3,428,143 as network upgrade NU6.3, ten days after zcashd shut itself down for good at block 3,417,100 and left the network running on Zebra and Zakura alone. On activation day Orchard held about 3.66M ZEC, then worth \$1.7B, and was sealed: no new deposits, withdrawals only, with the turnstile capping exits at the value that verifiably entered. The formal verification finished the same day: zkSecurity, ZODL, and Tachyon proved more than 2,700 theorems in Lean establishing the new circuit's balance integrity down to named assumptions. The proof says nothing about what happened inside Orchard before June; that is what the turnstile is for.

Migration ran ahead of the wallets. Ironwood held 133K ZEC at the close of activation day and about 180K by the next morning, before any wallet had a dedicated migration flow; Zodl's one-tap "Move to Ironwood" arrived on August 8, by which point Orchard had already lost 60% of its balance. ZecHub's dollar-weighted count reached 86% migrated on August 30. The only operational issue

on bug in shielded verification for the new 6.2.1 patched on July 22. No exploit, chain ad. From the May 29 disclosure to the episode took 93 days.

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NU7 has no mainnet activation height. It has a vote. Tachyon and the Valar Group opened a coinholder poll on August 25, using a snapshot at block 3,459,350 and a quorum of 1M ZEC held in Ironwood, that closes September 14. Five questions: replace halvings with the Network Sustainability Mechanism's smoothed issuance or keep them; when reissuance starts; whether to deprecate Sprout and v4 transactions; whether to adopt ZIP 218's 25-second blocks, tripling block frequency; and whether to ship NU7 by a September 30 target with unfinished features cut, delay it, or reject it. The Zcash Foundation opened a parallel ZCAP poll on the same questions on August 27. ZIP 248's transaction-format changes are out of scope regardless, and Zcash Shielded Assets remain in integration with Ironwood. As of the August 20 Arborist call nothing had been finalized.

ZODL

ZODL shipped ten wallet releases between July 1 and August 31, from 3.7.2 to 3.10.2. Three mattered: 3.8.0 on July 27, the day before activation, which made the wallet Ironwood-compatible; 3.9.0 on August 8 with the migration flow; and 3.10.0 on August 21, which restored coinholder polling for Ironwood balances in time for the NU7 vote. The team hosted the ZODL Summit in Prague on July 8 to 10, and Daira-Emma Hopwood co-authored the Ironwood proof. No new funding or staff changes were disclosed.

Zcash Foundation

The Foundation's quarter was release cadence. Zebra went from 6.0.0 on July 10, the mandatory pre-Ironwood build, to 6.3.0 on August 10, seven releases in a month carrying a dozen security advisories, three rated High. Zallet reached Beta 3 with the Least Authority audit in its second round. The Q2 report published August 6 showed \$963K of spend, 53% of it on protocol and Zebra work, and \$48.8M of liquid assets including 78,986 ZEC. The Foundation also took over the Zcash GitHub organization, the z.cash domain, and the @Zcash account from Electric Coin Company. Zcon7 runs October 27 to 29 in Cancún, with October 28 marking the network's tenth birthday.

Shielded Labs

osslink, its hybrid proof-of-stake finality
he feature-net forking investigation closed
he August 20 Arborist call, and a second
l-fork tooling and user-activated slashing.
r moved from Shielded Labs' roadmap to the
, with a halving-preserving alternative draft
ganization remains donation-funded.

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Tachyon

Tachyon's mainnet path still runs through the ZIP process with no date. The visible progress was in the tooling around it: Zakura, the Zebra-derived node co-maintained with the Valar Group, released Zakura Common on August 29, a cryptography stack that cuts mobile proving time from more than three seconds to under 200 milliseconds with no network upgrade required. Tachyon's Tal Derei contributed the third leg of the Ironwood proof, and Sean Bowe's team is coordinating the NU7 vote, the first production use of the private information retrieval that Tachyon's Oblivious Synchronization depends on.

Grayscale ZCSH and corporate treasuries

Grayscale's Zcash Trust converted to a spot ETF on NYSE Arca on August 25 after S-3 amendments on August 18 and 21, the first US-listed spot product for a privacy coin. The fund held 388,674 ZEC at June 30 per its 10-Q, charges 2.5%, and custodies at Coinbase. Creations began August 28: \$4.5M that day and \$8.9M on August 31, taking shares outstanding from 4.83M to 5.03M. Assets went from \$155M on June 30 to \$346M on August 31, most of the gain from price, with the share price within half a percent of NAV on every day since listing. Cypherpunk Technologies, the other listed accumulator, held 323K ZEC at an average cost of \$342 at the end of Q2. Wrapped ZEC on other chains was flat over the two months at about 240K.

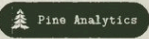




Grading Q2's Calls: Four of Five Resolved

What the Q2 report said to watch, and what Q3 delivered

Q2 call	Verdict	What happened
Ironwood migration	Resolved	87% of Orchard crossed in five weeks; 470K tail remains
NU7 mainnet, late July	Miss	No activation height; earliest ship date Sept 30
Shielded rebuild (745K)	Partly	440K back (59%); share 2.4 pts under April peak
NU7 scope: NSM + ZSA	Deferred	NSM is question one on the vote; ZSA not on ballot
zcashd sunset, block 3,417,100	Resolved	Halted July 18, exactly as stated



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h. Four resolved.

- **Ironwood migration.** Called the central question for Q3. Resolved: 87% of Orchard crossed in five weeks. The full re-verification the report described still waits on the 470K tail.
- **NU7 mainnet, targeted late July.** Miss. No activation height exists, and the earliest ship date on the ballot is September 30. The 300% throughput claim has not been tested in production.
- **Shielded rebuild, whether the 745K returns.** Partly. 440K, or 59%, came back by August 31, and the shielded share sits 2.4 points under its April peak.
- **Governance, final NU7 scope with NSM and ZSA.** Deferred to the vote. NSM is question one; ZSA is still in Ironwood integration and not on the ballot.
- **zcashd sunset near block 3,417,100.** Resolved exactly as stated, on July 18.



What to Watch in Q4
Five threads that decide the quarter ahead

Thread	Where it stands (Aug 31)	What resolves it
NU7 vote	Poll closes Sept 14; ship-by Sept 30	Ship or delay; 25s blocks; NSM
Orchard residual	470K ZEC left; 46K/week migrating	Tail clears, or a permanent stub
ETF demand	\$13M of creations in first two days	Rate holds past the listing week
Shielded share	28.7% vs 31% April peak	A break above 31% during a rally
Corporate hashrate	9,000 Z15 Pros due; Cypherpunk -18%	Mining addresses hold near 16/day

Data as of: August 31, 2026
Source: Pine Analytics, Blockworks Analytics

 Pine Analytics

What to Watch in Q4

16:43 · 10 сент. 2026 г. · 3,7 тыс. Просмотров

Two months into Q3, the Orchard episode is closed for 87% of the pool and the network is priced at \$14B, up from \$6.8B. Five threads will define the quarter ahead.

  2  27  13 

NU7 ... closes September 14 and the ship-by target is September 30. Whether the network cuts scope and ships, or delays, sets the ...

ides the Network Sustainability Mechanism. ... remained on August 31 and the weekly ... netner the tail clears or a permanent stub is ... can re-verify the whole shielded supply. ... k. ZCSH took \$13M of creations across its ...

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